[Crossover: Primarily Demon] Shadows in DC

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Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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[Crossover: Primarily Demon] Shadows in DC

#1

11-03-2015, 11:04 PM

So I'm planning to introduce my girlfriend to actually playing World of Darkness instead of just reading the short stories using a solo Demon game setting Washington. It will have a Mummy presence for sure, but I was wondering what else people had done with DC in the other splats. I've got and agency of 4-5 Unchained, plus the cult and resources of one "Mr. Song" who will start the game in a very long name and likely stay that way for a while. They act as political fixers ala Scandal, and have taken a newly fallen Demon (read: the PC) under their wing. I've also got an idea to have Beasts feature as a detective and/or political paparazzi. Any other thoughts?

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

Tags: None

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Vent0

11-04-2015, 06:41 AM

#2

Looking to expand the crossover, at all? Any Vampire politics (vampires love politics)?

Or are you looking for thoughts regarding the splats you've already listed? Or the city? Or the narrative theme?

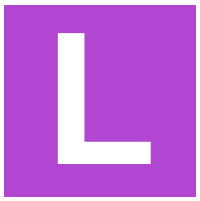
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Join Date: Aug 2015
Posts: 5184

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Malkydel: "And the Machine dictated; let there be adequate illumination."
Yossarian: "And lo, it was optimal."

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Leetsepeak
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 4259

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11-04-2015, 10:41 AM #3

Could look to Dave Brookshaw's Broken Diamond for inspiration as far as Mages are concerned.

I am no longer participating in the community. Please do not contact me about my previous work.

1

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Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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11-04-2015, 11:30 AM #4

> *Originally posted by **Vent0***
> *Looking to expand the crossover, at all? Any Vampire politics (vampires love politics)?*
>
> *Or are you looking for thoughts regarding the splats you've already listed? Or the city? Or the narrative theme?*

Yeah, I'd like a chance to at least intro all of the different splats in some capacity. Vampires will be one of the first things to show up for sure. Any ideas on what I've already mentioned, plot hooks, or themes would be greatly appreciated

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | Patreon| He/His | Currently Writing: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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Vent0
Member

Join Date: Aug 2015
Posts: 5184

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11-04-2015, 01:29 PM #5

Well, the presence of certain Hunter groups is practically a given (and could almost serve as a story in an of itself). Task Force: Valkyrie is obvious. As is VASCU. The Cheiron Group likely has lobbyists there. Ashwood Abby among the rich movers and shakers. The Union amongst their namesake special interests. Aegis Kai Doru might be limited to the museums (but make an excellent antagonist to the Mummies already mentioned). The Barrett Commission is also thematic (and can tie in well with any Vampire politics introduced).

Hunter might make a nice follow-up after the PC(s) encounter different supernatural groups.

As for Werewolf, the main factions I can see tying into the political theme are: Ivory Claws (for old money and entrenched power), Fire-Touched (for quasi-religious doom-sayers and rabble-rousers), Iron Masters (for their focus on human institutions), and Storm Lords (because having a politco or adviser Ridden/Claimed by a spirit of [Ideology] is just a gold mine). Blood Talons might hunt any of the other wolf groups (*likely* focusing on the Pure), but might easily get branded as terrorists, adding some additional complexity to the situation.

How knowledgeable of the supernatural are the PC(s) targets/allies and rivals? Are they keeping their "help" hidden from their beneficiaries? Or are they "in the know"?

End-game consideration: Depending on how subtle events progress, might this lead to a World of Darkness: Revealed situation on Live television?

Other Plot Ideas:

- Someone seeks an edge up over their competition by bargaining with one of the True Fae to forge a contract between them and [Capitalism, Freedom, Patriotism, The American Dream, etc.]. As for their part of the bargain? Well, the cash-for-kids scandal was going on for a while... similar concept/set-up?
- Something is riling up key personal at the Pentagon, causing more of them to agitate for war and preemptive strikes against the US's enemies - both real and imagined. A Zeka's Disquiet is infecting them - but the better question is: how was a Zeka even able to interact enough with them for Disquiet to take effect?
- The Seers of the Throne and the Pentacle have been waging their own cold war in the halls of power for years. A game changing artifact or event could break the deadlock and give either side an advantage... or turn the cold war into a hot one.
- An ally has been complaining of political sabotage and minor acts of terror being committed against them by their rivals. They are partially right: the ally is being haunted by the ghosts of those they've wrong/betrayed (or who are merely convinced they have been) in the ally's rise to power.
- An Occult Matrix requires a particular political upset to occur - one that will benefit the PCs. Will they allow it to come to pass as the God-Machine intends, or seek to stop it despite the cost to their own political plots and ambitions?

Themes for consideration:

- Compromises: In the games of cut-throat politics, ideals are often the first casualties, and rarely do both sides get exactly what they want.

- Strange Bedfellows: In the climb to the top, even former rivals might become allies of the moment.
- Public Relations: When it comes to popularly elected positions, image can become everything.

Last edited by Vent0; 11-04-2015, 01:49 PM.

Malkydel: "And the Machine dictated; let there be adequate illumination."
Yossarian: "And lo, it was optimal."

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Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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11-08-2015, 12:42 PM #6

Thanks! That's really helpful!

> *Originally posted by **Vent0***
> *Well, the presence of certain Hunter groups is practically a given (and could almost serve as a story in an of itself). Task Force: Valkyrie is obvious. As is VASCU. The Cheiron Group likely has lobbyists there. Ashwood Abby among the rich movers and shakers. The Union amongst their namesake special interests. Aegis Kai Doru might be limited to the museums (but make an excellent antagonist to the Mummies already mentioned). The Barrett Commission is also thematic (and can tie in well with any Vampire politics introduced).*
>
> *Hunter might make a nice follow-up after the PC(s) encounter different supernatural groups.*

Hunters were definitely one of the first places I was thinking of going. We're still in the Character Creation stage, but having the cover work in the Smithsonian would definitely mean that the Aegis will show up a lot. Valkyrie, VASCU, and Cheiron were all things I had tagged before, but I totally forgot about the Barrett Commission! I'm also planning to build in The Knights of Saint Adrian and Utopia Now from Mortal Remains too. The Knights will serve as antagonists for the Demons, while Utopia Now antagonizes the Demons, Angels, and mortal bureaucracies of DC. Some of them may be politicians, while others may closer to out and out domestic terrorists.

> *Originally posted by **Vent0***
> *As for Werewolf, the main factions I can see tying into the political theme are: Ivory Claws (for old money and entrenched power), Fire-Touched (for quasi-religious doom-sayers and rabble-rousers), Iron Masters (for their focus on human institutions), and Storm Lords (because having a politco or adviser Ridden/Claimed by a spirit of [Ideology] is just a gold mine). Blood Talons might hunt any of the other wolf groups (likely focusing on the Pure), but might easily get branded as terrorists, adding some additional complexity to the situation.*

This is awesome! I knew that Iron Masters would play a big role, but I was stuck on everything else. All of your suggestions make perfect sense!

> *Originally posted by* ***Vent0***
>
> *End-game consideration: Depending on how subtle events progress, might this lead to a World of Darkness: Revealed situation on Live television?*

Possibly. I definitely think that many of the major players in any national government in WoD would know about some aspects of the supernatural, but not necessarily all parts. I can definitely see some small scale or limited revels to the mortal world.

Depending how things has out with Promethean 2.0, I may try and make some of the movers and shakers that aren't part of the public eye The Created. Things like campaign managers or radio pundits who are well along their Pilgrimage.

Now I just need to figure out how I want to frame my Changeling courts and GM Infrastruture.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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Vent0
Member

Join Date: Aug 2015
Posts: 5184

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11-08-2015, 01:26 PM #7

> *Originally posted by* ***Second Chances***
>
> *Thanks! That's really helpful!*

You're welcome. I'm glad my rambling is of some use.

> *Originally posted by* ***Second Chances***
>
> *Depending how things has out with Promethean 2.0, I may try and make some of the movers and shakers that aren't part of the public eye The Created. Things like campaign managers or radio pundits who are well along their Pilgrimage.*

They'd have to be *very* reclusive. Disquiet and the Wasteland are still a thing, albeit reduced, from what I understand.

> *Originally posted by* ***Second Chances***
>
> *Now I just need to figure out how I want to frame my Changeling courts and GM Infrastruture.*

Hmm. Basing the Courts around political parties may be going too far, but you might have Court rotation based on election, rather than calendar.

As for G-M Infrastructure: there is *soooo* much to choose from. You just know the

various monuments have Occult significance. Baltimore is in The Demon Seed Collection, which is close to DC.

Malkydel: "And the Machine dictated; let there be adequate illumination."
Yossarian: "And lo, it was optimal."

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Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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11-10-2015, 12:05 AM #8

Totally! Even pointing out Baltimore helps a lot. I'm pretty good with world geography, but I've never lived in the U.S. so specific cities can be tougher for me to place.

I'm almost thinking the Courts of DC should be based around the powers of government... Like a Court of Representatives, Court of the White House, Court of the Senate, Court of the Justices, and (possibly) Court of the States. Respectively, their emotions would be something like determination, ambition, perseverance, detachment, and defiance. It's just a thought though, I'll have to play with it more.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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Madfox11
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 172

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11-10-2015, 04:18 AM #9

> *Originally posted by* ***Second Chances***
> *Totally! Even pointing out Baltimore helps a lot. I'm pretty good with world geography, but I've never lived in the U.S. so specific cities can be tougher for me to place.*
>
> *I'm almost thinking the Courts of DC should be based around the powers of government... Like a Court of Representatives, Court of the White House, Court of the Senate, Court of the Justices, and (possibly) Court of the States. Respectively, their emotions would be something like determination, ambition, perseverance, detachment, and defiance. It's just a thought though, I'll have to play with it more.*

The Courts of Changelings work based on change and cycles. Without such change it does not work as well against the Gentry, although I am not entirely sure how this might change in 2e. Your suggestion are too static. I would stick to a more traditional model, although I am also liking the idea of the Day and Night Court which would work relatively well with the two political party system of the USA (and no, neither day nor night are evil 😉).

One question, are you sure you (a) want to use everything when running a game for a newbie and (b) you can actually do any of the games justice when you do? You run the risk of overwhelming them with too much information and run the risk to give them the thought the supernatural is common. Then again, if there would be a place with a high number of different supernaturals it would be Washington DC

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Vent0
Member

Join Date: Aug 2015
Posts: 5184

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11-10-2015, 08:10 AM #10

> *Originally posted by **Madfox11***
> *One question, are you sure you (a) want to use everything when running a game for a newbie and (b) you can actually do any of the games justice when you do? You run the risk of overwhelming them with too much information and run the risk to give them the thought the supernatural is common. Then again, if there would be a place with a high number of different supernaturals it would be Washington DC*

Seconded. It might be best not to throw everything in at once, or risk diluting themes and impressions. Maybe think of it like a TV show? Have each facet you want to explore a "season", with it's own themes and supernatural show-cased, and only move on to a new group once one is wrapped up (but, obviously, recurring characters and plot threads a thing). Let's you explore each in turn, but still give them time to shine.

Of course, throwing them all in together gives a certain "mad house" and "crowded shadows" theme of its own.

Malkydel: "And the Machine dictated; let there be adequate illumination."
Yossarian: "And lo, it was optimal."

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Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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11-10-2015, 05:14 PM #11

> *Originally posted by **Madfox11***
>
> *The Courts of Changelings work based on change and cycles. Without such change it does not work as well against the Gentry, although I am not entirely sure how this might change in 2e. Your suggestion are too static. I would stick to a more traditional model, although I am also liking the idea of the Day and Night Court which would work relatively well with the two political party system of the USA (and no, neither day nor night are evil).*

I'm going to have to disagree on this point. Look at the courts of the Upper Michigan in the court creation document. Those are all based around different economic facets of the area. Some of them are seasonal, but others are very,

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very static. Same thing with the Freehold of Toronto, Ruby is a static thing, but it ties into the Bulwark and story. So the question is, what do those five courts I came up with relate to? How could they form a bulwark that is repeatable?

If the True Fae understand one thing, it is power. The ability to be absolute masters of their domains. What they absolutely do not understand is why someone would give that. Someone like the general who helped to create the Nation. Someone like George Washington. So the mystical resonance is Washington's life story and his decision to voluntarily give up power. Likely, the Bulwark ritual will also involve the ceding of power to another court. To me, that transition on a yearly basis would be more than enough to hold the Fae at bay,

> *Originally posted by **Madfox11***
>
> *One question, are you sure you (a) want to use everything when running a game for a newbie and (b) you can actually do any of the games justice when you do? You run the risk of overwhelming them with too much information and run the risk to give them the thought the supernatural is common. Then again, if there would be a place with a high number of different supernaturals it would be Washington DC* 😉

That's a fair question. I'll have to think about it, but I wasn't planning on getting all of the intricacies of each line included. The main focus is definitely going to be on the Demons, with a secondary on Mummies and maybe Vampires. Think of it as the problem of the week formula... Different supernaturalist may show up for a couple of episodes, but the season stays focused on the main problem. Maybe a bit of a shorter scale than what Vent is suggesting, although that would work too.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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